

HUSAM AHMED

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Hiring Manager

Health Technology and Systems Team
Canada's Drug Agency (CDA-AMC)

Re: Clinical Research Assistant (Temporary)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm applying for the Clinical Research Assistant role because the day-to-day work, preliminary screening and article selection from literature searches, extracting data from studies, drafting and revising reports, and supporting committee outputs, parallels what I'm already doing at Stelis Environmental Solutions on an evidence-based review of a new monitoring technology, just applied to a different domain.

At Stelis Environmental Solutions, I'm the junior researcher on the team's evidence-based review of ColiMinder, a relatively new real-time enzymatic microbial monitoring technology, as a possible supplement or replacement for culture-based drinking-water testing. The work feeds analytical findings to senior project leads against a structured set of review questions. I do the preliminary screening and article selection on peer-reviewed literature covering enzymatic β -glucuronidase detection across water matrices and conditions, and I trace the regulatory landscape across Health Canada GCDWQ, Ontario Regulations 169/03 and 170/03, and US EPA drinking-water rules to identify where the technology is accepted and the gating criteria for acceptance.

From there I extract and structure data from pilot studies in Excel, aligning paired samples by site and timestamp (real-time readings against culture references that return 24 to 48 hours later), calculating concordance, isolating false positives and false negatives, and surfacing clustering patterns by site, matrix, or timing that the team uses to tune thresholds and sampling frequency. I build and maintain Power BI heat maps of microbial, chemical, lead, and nitrate exceedances across Canadian and US jurisdictions from public Health Canada, US EPA, and provincial reports, and synthesize findings into comparison tables and briefing notes that project leads use to weigh speed of detection (the public-health benefit of faster response to contamination), verification rigour, and regulatory acceptance. Alongside this I draft and revise the consolidated SOP and maintain the regulatory change log to keep procedures current as federal and provincial rules evolve.

At IRCC's Operations Support Centre, my parallel federal role trains the same habit applied to a different body of text: I read authority language under the Immigration and Refugee Protection Act (IRPA) carefully and document the reasoning behind each case decision so the file holds full context for downstream review.

My BSc in Biology from the University of Ottawa is the foundation: microbiology coursework, statistical analysis of lab datasets in Excel, and technical lab reports laying out methods, results, and limitations. I'd be honest about where I'd be starting from. I haven't done formal systematic review or meta-analysis work yet, my understanding of the Canadian health-care system at the federal, provincial, and territorial levels is built from a regulatory habit rather than a health-system one, and I know your team's reviews more often examine pharmaceuticals than instruments. All three are things I'd want to develop quickly under senior team members at CDA-AMC, and they're a real part of what drew me to this role: the work translates evidence into decisions that shape Canadians' access to medicines, and that feels like a meaningful place to learn evidence synthesis under people who do it well.

Outside of work I keep a habit of close-reading neuroscience and biology papers from my undergrad coursework and writing short notes on each one, mostly to make sure careful reading stays a daily practice rather than a school skill.

I have working knowledge of French and am building toward fluency, I'm eligible for federal security clearance, and I'm currently managing multiple priorities across two simultaneous roles. I'd value the chance to bring this combination to the Health Technology and Systems team.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Husam Ahmed